SHOPINBOS

FREE WORKBOOK · 2026 EDITION

Online Store Platform Comparison Worksheet

Feeling confused by all the options for building an online store? You're not alone. For a new business owner, the technical words and long feature lists can be a lot to take in. The...



7 pages · PDF

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What's inside

3 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

01 The Pre-Launch Checklist: Know Yourself First

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03 Your First Week Action Plan

Feeling confused by all the options for building an online store? You're not alone. For a new business owner, the technical words and long feature lists can be a lot to take in. The secret isn't to find the "best" platform overall, but the best platform for *you*.

This starter kit is built around a simple comparison worksheet that cuts through the noise. We'll help you work out what you actually need before you ever tap a "sign up" button. Let's turn that confusion into a clear plan.

01 The Pre-Launch Checklist: Know Yourself First

Before comparing Shopinbos, Shopify, Wix or any other platform, look at your own business first. Your business is unique, and your platform should match it. Grab a notebook and answer these three basic questions.

1. The product and vision

- What are you selling? (e.g. clothes and ankara, hair and beauty, gadgets, food like zobo and small chops, digital downloads, services)
- How many products will you start with? (e.g. 1–10, 10–50, 50+)
- Where will you get them? (your own production, markets like Balogun or Aba, or suppliers you can dropship from, meaning they deliver straight to your customer)
- What is your brand's feel? (e.g. sleek and premium, handmade and cultural, fun and playful)

Why it matters: A store with 3 custom T-shirt designs needs something different from a store with 200 pieces of thrift fashion. Your brand feel also decides how much control you need over the design.

2. The budget and how you get paid

- What can you realistically spend on *platform fees* each month, in naira?
- Is the platform billed in naira or in US dollars? (Dollar billing on a Nigerian card can fail or cost more as the exchange rate moves.)
- Are you okay paying a small fee on each sale, or do you prefer a fixed monthly fee instead?
- How will customers pay you? (e.g. Paystack, Flutterwave, bank transfer, USSD, pay on delivery)

Why it matters: Hidden fees are a beginner's biggest trap. Knowing the full cost upfront saves you money and stress later.

3. Your skills and time

- Rate your tech skills: (1 = "I need something that just works on my phone," 5 = "I'm happy learning new software").
- How much time can you give to building and running your store each week?
- Do you want to handle delivery, receipts and getting found on Google yourself, or do you need the platform to guide you?

Why it matters: If you're short on time and tech skills, a simple all-in-one platform is your best friend. If you love tinkering, you have more options.

02 Your Platform Comparison Worksheet

Now take your answers from the checklist and use them to compare platforms. Copy the table below into Google Sheets or a notebook and fill it in.

Feature to Compare	Your Priority (High/Med/Low)	Platform A:	Platform B:	Platform C:
Monthly cost (and naira or dollar billing)				
Fee per sale				
Ease of use (1–5)				
Design freedom				
Can you build and manage it from your phone?				
Nigerian payments (Paystack, Flutterwave, transfer)				
Pay on delivery option				
Delivery partners (GIG, Kwik, Sendbox)				
Selling on WhatsApp, Instagram, TikTok and Facebook				
Tools to get found on Google (SEO)				
Reminders for customers who leave items in the cart				
Stock tracking				
Customer support quality (and Nigerian hours)				
Add-ons and extra apps				

How to use this worksheet well:

1. **Set your priority:** Based on your checklist answers, mark each feature High, Medium or Low. For example, if your budget is tight, “Monthly cost” is High. If you’re not confident with tech, “Ease of use” is High. If most of your customers are in Lagos and like to pay cash, “Pay on delivery” is High.

2. **Research and fill in:** Visit the websites of two or three platforms, for example Shopinbos, Shopify and Wix. Use their free plans or free trials! As you explore, fill in each column.
3. **Choose your winner:** The platform that best covers your High priority boxes is likely your winner. Don't get distracted by fancy features you marked Low.

For example, Chidi sells phone accessories in Ikeja and takes most orders on WhatsApp and Instagram. For him, Nigerian payments, delivery and selling on social media are all High. Shopinbos covers these in one place: Rex builds the store, payments and deliveries are managed in the same app, and Peggy, the AI assistant, helps reply to customer chats. It's free to start; see shopinbos.com/pricing for plans.

03 Your First Week Action Plan

You've chosen a platform! Now what? Here's a simple, calm plan for your first seven days.

- **Day 1:** Sign up on the free plan or trial. Skip paid plans for now. Take the platform's welcome tour.
- **Day 2:** Upload your FIRST product. Just one. Learn how to add a name, description, price in naira and one clear photo.
- **Day 3:** Play with the design templates. Pick one you like and change the colours and fonts to feel like your brand.
- **Day 4:** Set up your basic pages: a privacy policy, terms of sale, and a returns and delivery policy. You can find simple examples online; keep them in line with Nigeria's data protection rules.
- **Day 5:** Set your delivery options for one area first (e.g. Lagos, with a dispatch rider or GIG Logistics), including fees and how long it takes.
- **Day 6:** Connect a payment option (like Paystack or Flutterwave) in test mode, and decide if you will offer pay on delivery.
- **Day 7:** Pat yourself on the back! You have the foundation of a live online store. Share the link on your WhatsApp status.

Remember, perfect is the enemy of done. Your goal is to launch and learn, not to have a flawless store on day one. This worksheet is your first step from idea to action.

Want more help? For step-by-step guides on setting up your store, explore our beginner guides on Shopinbos.com. We break it down so you can build it up.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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